

Daily Need to Know

Saturday, 15 August 2026 · Pre-market brief

Coverage window, capture method and edition notes are at the back, in section 16.

1 Market snapshot — the close, and where it is trading now

ASSET	LAST	CHANGE	NOTE
S&P 500 settled	7,785.76	▼ 13.23 (−0.17%)	Range 7,776.31–7,810.01. Closed 13 points under Thursday's record close of 7,798.99 and 31 under the 7,816.70 intraday record. Third straight weekly gain, +0.4%.
Nasdaq Composite settled	26,729.16	▼ 73.86 (−0.28%)	Range 26,661.95–26,862.17; closed in the bottom third of it. Still 461 points (1.7%) below the 27,190.21 record. Weekly gain of just 0.1% — the third in a row, and the thinnest.
Dow Jones settled	53,732.41	▼ 107.58 (−0.20%)	The only major index lower on the week , −0.6%. Sits 1,012 points below its 54,744.33 high. Health care and staples weight is doing the damage.
Russell 2000 settled	3,068.42	▲ 15.57 (+0.51%)	New record. Friday's 3,069.71 high is the 52-week high, and it closed 1.29 off it. The only major index green on the day.
Philadelphia SOX settled	12,417.04	▼ 38.96 (−0.31%)	Range 12,269.44–12,495.15 — a 225.7-point, 1.8% swing on a −0.3% close. Still 15.3% below the 14,655.29 high set before the July drawdown.
ES E-mini S&P Fri settle	7,805.00	▼ 17.50 (−0.22%)	Globex shut 17:00 ET; no live level exists. 19.24 premium to cash. Volume 839,974 — an ordinary summer Friday.
NQ E-mini Nasdaq-100 Fri settle	30,141.75	▼ 46.75 (−0.16%)	Range 30,028.50–30,283.00. Volume 398,169. Held above 30,000 all session.
YM E-mini Dow Fri settle	53,807	▼ 128 (−0.24%)	74.6 over cash. Volume 43,243 — the thinnest of the four, and the worst contract to read anything into.
RTY E-mini Russell Fri settle	3,074.90	▲ 14.70 (+0.48%)	The only green contract . 6.48 over cash. Volume 101,924.
US 10-year settled	4.692%	▲ 4.3bp	Range 4.625–4.698 — closed one basis point off the session high, on the worst retail sales print since May 2025 . That is the wrong direction for a growth scare.
US 30-year settled	5.261%	▲ 4.2bp	Back above 5.25%. The long end led. 30s10s at 56.9bp.
US 5-year settled	4.362%	▲ 3.9bp	Belly followed the long end rather than the data.
US 13-week bill settled	3.790%	▼ 2.0bp	The only maturity that fell. 2-year at 4.171% (+2.2bp) leaves 10s2s at 52.1bp — a steepener that worked on the data.
WTI crude (CL front) Fri settle	\$82.40	▲ 1.15 (+1.42%)	Range 80.71–82.99. Energy was the week's best sector by a distance, roughly +7%. Hormuz traffic is still a fraction of pre-war levels.
Brent (BZ front) Fri settle	\$88.52	▲ 1.45 (+1.67%)	Outpaced WTI; the spread widened to \$6.12. The premium is a shipping-risk premium, not a demand one.
Natural gas (NG front) Fri settle	\$2.733	▲ 0.006 (+0.22%)	Range 2.710–2.783. Sits at 61.0% of its Hedgeye band while the TREND signal is bearish — an awkward pairing.
RBOB gasoline (RB front) Fri settle	\$2.9044	◆ n/m	Do not read the printed −7.15%. It is measured against a 3.128 reference while the contract's own session ran 2.8327–2.9096 and closed <i>above</i> its 2.8496 open. A roll discontinuity, not a price move. Intra-session it was +1.9%.
Gold spot Fri close	\$4,376.33	▲ 25.03 (+0.58%)	Spot — the series Hedgeye's band names. Range 4,311.01–4,396.95. December futures settled 4,437.30, a 1.39% basis ; reading the band on futures would misplace it by 19 percentage points.
Silver spot Fri close	\$64.685	▲ 0.253 (+0.39%)	Range 63.512–65.701 — a 3.4% intraday swing on a 0.4% close. Futures 65.108, a 0.65% basis.
Copper spot Fri close	\$6.5595/lb	▲ 0.0202 (+0.31%)	Futures 6.613, a 0.82% basis. Sits at 33.2% of the band on spot versus 51.0% on futures — the single largest measurement trap in the list.
DX-Y Fri close	99.636	▼ 0.312 (−0.31%)	Range 99.475–99.936. Fell on the data, as it should have. Hedgeye is short the dollar and calls long USD the most consensus net-long position in macro.
USD/JPY Fri close	159.316	▼ 0.20 (−0.13%)	Low 158.602. Still within a whisker of the intervention conversation, but the yen is a Hedgeye long.

USD/KRW Fri close	1,416.64	▼ 1.30 (−0.09%)	Traded as low as 1,408.25. The won firmed as the KOSPI added 2.42% and closed back in a bull market.
VIX settled	14.26	▼ 0.38 (−2.60%)	Range 14.18–14.72. Just 0.88 above the 13.38 52-week low and 8.8% of the way up its own Hedgeye band. Volatility is priced for nothing to happen.
Bitcoin LIVE 06:07:13	\$62,875.88	▼ 545.08 (−0.86%)	The only genuinely live row in this table. Range 62,488–63,553. 50.2% below the 126,230 record. Hedgeye has Bitcoin bearish on both TRADE and TREND.

Colour key: ▲ green = higher on the session; ▼ red = lower; ♦ amber = not meaningful. For yields, the glyph follows the yield and the colour follows the bond, so a rising yield prints red. Reconciliation: cash index changes were verified against their own prior closes (S&P −13.23 on 7,798.99 = −0.16964%, matching the vendor's −0.16964%; the same test passed for the Nasdaq, Dow, Russell and SOX). Futures were checked against Friday's settle and against cash basis. All rows other than Bitcoin are Friday closes or settles, not live prints — Globex, cash FX and the metals fixes are all shut for the weekend.

TL;DR

The Russell 2000 made a record high on the worst consumer data of the year, and it was the only major index that went up. Retail sales fell 0.6% in July against a +0.1% consensus, the sharpest drop since May 2025, and the University of Michigan's preliminary August sentiment collapsed to 51.0 against 54.5 expected. Small caps rallied anyway. Rotation, not growth, is doing the work.

The bond market disagreed with the equity market's reading. Ten-year yields rose 4.3bp to 4.692% and the 30-year rose 4.2bp on a downside consumer miss, while the 13-week bill fell 2.0bp. That is bear steepening into weak data — a fiscal and inflation-premium response, not a growth-scare one, and it sits badly with a Nasdaq at record territory.

Hedgeye's risk ranges narrowed almost everywhere at the highs. The S&P band tightened 53 points versus Thursday, the Nasdaq band by 503, the Russell by 15 and the VIX ceiling by 0.51. The Russell now sits at **92.5%** of its band while VIX sits at **8.8%** of its own. Both ends are stretched at the same time.

The AI complex split down the middle. Memory ran — SanDisk +7.4%, Western Digital +4.4%, Micron +2.3% — while equipment and custom silicon were sold: Applied Materials −5.1% and Broadcom −5.9%. Keith McCullough covered his South Korea and DRAM shorts on the signal change, then went from eight longs and zero shorts to seven longs and two shorts as the tape hit highs.

2 The big picture — what it means

1. A record small-cap high printed on the worst consumer data of the year, and that combination is the whole story of the session. Retail sales fell 0.6% month-on-month against a +0.1% consensus and decelerated to +5.0% year-on-year from 6.7% in June and a revised 7.3% in May. Michigan sentiment printed 51.0 against 54.5. And the Russell 2000 closed at 3,068.42, up 0.51%, having touched 3,069.71 — its 52-week high — while the S&P, Nasdaq and Dow all closed red. Small caps are not rallying on the consumer. They are rallying on the front end of the curve and on a Quad rotation that says September is Quad 1.

2. The bond market's response is the number nobody led with. On a downside consumer miss you expect yields to fall. They rose: 10-year +4.3bp to 4.692%, 30-year +4.2bp to 5.261%, 5-year +3.9bp. The only maturity that fell was the 13-week bill, −2.0bp to 3.790%. That is the curve steepening from the long end on bad news, which is what you get when the market prices weaker growth *and* a stickier term premium at the same time. With CPI still at 3.4% year-on-year, an energy shock still unresolved and a Fed that voted 9–3 in July with three members wanting a *hike*, the long end is not being offered the growth-scare bid it would have been offered in a normal cycle.

3. Every equity risk range Hedgeye publishes narrowed into the highs, and that is a compression signal, not a comfort signal. The S&P band went from 7,576–7,884 to 7,606–7,861 — 53 points tighter, with the floor up 30 and the ceiling down 23. The Nasdaq band tightened by 503 points, the Russell by 15, the equal-weight RSP by one point, high yield by seven cents. Narrowing bands mean realised volatility is falling. Falling realised volatility at all-time highs with the Russell at 92.5% of its band and VIX at 8.8% of its own is precisely the configuration that gives you no cushion when something arrives.

4. The AI trade is no longer one trade. Memory went one way and equipment went the other, on the same day, in the same index. SanDisk +7.4%, Western Digital +4.4%, Micron +2.3% against Applied Materials −5.1% and Broadcom −5.9%. The SOX finished −0.31% and the semiconductor ETFs barely moved — SOXX −0.06%, SMH −0.22% — which is exactly what you would expect when the components are cancelling each other out rather than moving together. DRAM and NAND contract prices rose 93–98% and 85–90% quarter-on-quarter in Q1 and a further 58–63% and 55–60% in Q2; that is a supply story with its own clock, and it has decoupled from the capex story.

5. Energy is the quarter's trade, and it is a war trade. WTI settled \$82.40, up 1.42%, Brent \$88.52, up 1.67%, and the energy sector closed the week up roughly 7% — the best of the eleven. This is not a demand story. Strait of Hormuz transits have been running at a fraction of the roughly 130 a day that crossed before the conflict, the IEA has warned that stockpile draw is becoming pressing, and Iran's foreign minister has tied any reopening to sanctions relief and reparations. Petrol above \$4 a gallon through the Michigan survey window is the mechanism by which the war shows up in the consumer print. The two headline data misses on Friday and the energy sector's weekly win are the same event seen from two ends.

6. Crypto did not get the memo, and the divergence is now structural. Bitcoin was at \$62,875.88 at capture, down 0.86% on the day and 50.2% below its record. Ether at \$1,879.12 broke back into bearish TREND and Hedgeye removed the long — the ETF Pro sell notice went out at 22:40 GMT+8 on Friday. In a session where the Russell made a record and volatility fell, the highest-beta risk asset in the world went down. Either equity breadth is telling the truth about liquidity or crypto is; they cannot both be right.

7. The calendar does the talking from Wednesday. July FOMC minutes land at 02:00 GMT+8 on Thursday, into a market that has been given a September hike hint by a Fed that already has three dissenters wanting one. Walmart, Target, Lowe's, TJX and Home Depot all report inside the same window — the entire US consumer, priced, in the same week the consumer data broke. Whatever the retail sales print left ambiguous, the retailers will settle.

3 Rates, currencies & commodities

- **Bear steepening on weak data.** 10s2s widened to 52.1bp (10-year 4.692%, 2-year 4.171%) and 30s10s to 56.9bp. Hedgeye has carried a yield-curve steepener as a stated position; Friday paid it. The 13-week bill at 3.790% was the only maturity to rally.
- **Bond volatility is not confirming the equity calm — but it is close.** The MOVE index closed 69.58, up 0.51% on the day and comfortably below the 75 line Hedgeye has cited as supportive of risk assets. Low rate vol with a rising long end is an unusual pairing and worth watching more than the VIX.
- **Credit did nothing, which is itself information.** HYG -0.10% at 79.71, LQD -0.40% at 106.12, TLT -0.67% at 82.04. Investment grade underperformed high yield on a day yields rose — duration, not credit. LQD remains one of Hedgeye's largest macro shorts and sits at 35.0% of a band that itself narrowed 30 cents.
- **The dollar fell on the data and is a consensus long.** DXY -0.31% to 99.636, with EUR/USD +0.33% to 1.15670, GBP/USD +0.30% to 1.35264 and AUD/USD +0.32% to 0.70822. USD/CNH at 6.73985 is a notably firm yuan; USD/TWD fell 0.52% to 31.924, the largest Asian FX move of the session and a direct read-through to Taiwan's tech exporters.
- **Gold made the high of its week on the data.** Spot \$4,376.33, +0.58%, with a 4,396.95 intraday high. Hedgeye added to gold again on Friday's Macro Show and moved it up the asset-allocation ranking. GLD +0.63%, SLV +0.55%.
- **Wheat was the largest commodity move on the board and nobody will mention it.** Chicago SRW wheat settled 674.75, +3.37%, on a 652.50–677.25 range. In a session where the biggest equity move was 6%, a 3.4% move in the world's most politically sensitive soft commodity, in a year with a Black Sea shipping war, deserves a line.
- **The RBOB print is a trap.** The -7.15% on the screen is a roll discontinuity against a 3.128 reference. The contract closed at 2.9044, above its own 2.8496 open. Anyone reading a 7% gasoline collapse into the consumer story is reading an artefact.

4 Hedgeye — regime, risk ranges & the Quad path

MACRO DASHBOARD

ITEM	READING	CHANGE / IMPLICATION
Quad path	3 → 1 → 2	Monthly Quad Count of 3-1-2: August Quad 3, September Quad 1, October Quad 2. Unchanged from Thursday's set — but it is a live shift out of Quad 3, and the book is being moved for it.
Live risk-range set	Friday 14 Aug Early Look	"Quad Shift = ATHs", Keith McCullough, published 08:10 EDT / 20:10 GMT+8, 14 Aug . This is the newest set that exists; Hedgeye does not publish at weekends, so it governs the Saturday, Sunday and Monday editions. Superseded by Monday evening's Early Look (GMT+8).
Real-Time Alerts	7 longs / 2 shorts	Moved from 8 longs / 0 shorts during Friday's session. Three longs sold, inventory replaced, two shorts initiated at the top of the range.
Portfolio changes on the week	QTUM, IGV in; XLRE, IAK out	Quantum and software added; all REIT exposure and the remaining insurance position sold. Described as "a textbook Quad Shift".
Shorts covered	South Korea (EWY), Semis (DRAM)	Covered on the TRADE signal change, not on a change of view — the semiconductor move is still described as a bubble. KOSPI reclaimed the 6,853 TRADE level.
ETF Pro change	Ethereum (ETHA) removed	Issued 10:40 EDT / 22:40 GMT+8, 14 Aug . Removal from the long side means TRADE and/or TREND broke — sell.
Bond volatility	MOVE 69.58	Below trend and below the 75 line, cited on the Macro Show as supportive of risk assets and of the steepener.
Stated immediate-term upside	~0.7–0.8% on the S&P	Which is why the process moved to selling strength rather than buying it. Measured from Thursday's close, that implies a ceiling near 7,853–7,861.

Timestamps converted from US Eastern daylight time at GMT+8 = ET + 12 hours.

RISK RANGE™ SIGNALS — FULL TABLE, MEASURED ON FRIDAY'S SETTLES

INSTRUMENT	IMMEDIATE-TERM	TREND	WHERE IT STANDS NOW, AND HOW THE BAND MOVED
S&P 500 (SPX) 7,785.76	7,606–7,861	bullish	70.5% of band. 75 points from the ceiling. Band tightened 53 points (floor +30, ceiling –23) — the compression is the message.
Nasdaq Comp (COMPQ) 26,729.16	25,908–26,992	bullish	75.8% of band. Band tightened 503 points , floor up 375 — the largest single-day narrowing on the sheet.
Russell 2000 (RUT) 3,068.42	2,987–3,075	bullish	92.5% of band — the most stretched instrument here. 6.58 from the ceiling on a record close. Band tightened 15 points.
Equal Weight (RSP) 222.77	219.00–225.00	bullish	62.8%. Band shifted up 2 / 1 and tightened by 1. Breadth confirming, but not leading.
VIX 14.26	14.05–16.43	bearish	8.8% of band — 0.21 off the floor. Ceiling fell 0.51 . There is almost no room left below.
10Y UST yield 4.692%	4.60–4.74	bullish	65.7%. Floor rose 1bp, ceiling unchanged — the only band on the sheet that <i>widened</i> at the bottom. Bullish TREND on yield means higher, not lower.
High Yield (HYG) 79.71	79.43–79.98	bullish	50.9% — dead centre. Band shifted up 24 / 17 cents and tightened 7. Credit is not flashing.
Inv. Grade (LQD) 106.12	105.70–106.90	bearish	35.0%. Band tightened 30 cents. A named large macro short, in the lower half, with a bearish TREND.
Health Care (XLV) 167.37	164–172	bullish	42.1%. Whole band shifted up a point, width unchanged. XLV was the worst sector on Friday, –0.60% , against a bullish TREND — the cleanest long-side dip on the sheet.
Software (IGV)	99.00–110.00	bullish	New entry , replacing XLRE after the REIT sale. IGV was not in this morning's price capture, so its position in the band is not measured here rather than estimated. It rose 3.7% on Thursday.
US Dollar (USD/DXY) 99.636	99.25–100.13	bearish	43.9%. Band shifted down 15 / 10 and widened 5 — the only widening band on the sheet. Bearish TREND, lower half, consensus long.
WTI crude (WTIC) \$82.40 cont.	74.36–85.99	neutral	69.1%. Band shifted up 82c / 132c and widened. TREND upgraded from bearish to neutral versus Thursday — the only signal change on the sheet, and it is the war.
Nat gas (NATGAS) \$2.733 cont.	2.55–2.85	bearish	61.0%. Band essentially unchanged. Upper half of a bearish-TREND band is the least comfortable place on the page.
Gold spot \$4,376.33	4,201–4,524	bullish	54.3% on spot. On December futures it would read 73.2% — a 19-point error from a 1.39% basis. Band tightened 33 points.
Copper spot \$6.5595	6.46–6.76	bullish	33.2% on spot versus 51.0% on futures. Band tightened 10 cents, floor up 6.
Silver spot \$64.685	58–68	neutral	66.9% on spot , 71.1% on futures. The only band identical to Thursday's. Widest band on the sheet in percentage terms — 17% of the midpoint.

Levels from the Early Look "Quad Shift = ATHs", 20:10 GMT+8, 14 Aug 2026. Prior-day comparison against "PLAY THE HAND YOU'RE DEALT", Brooks Cutright, 19:17 GMT+8, 13 Aug 2026. Metals measured on spot (TVC:GOLD, TVC:SILVER, OANDA:XCUUSD) and energy on the continuous contract (NYMEX:CL1!, NYMEX:NG1!) because those are the series the published lines name. Real Estate (XLRE) dropped off the sheet with the position; Software (IGV) replaced it.

WHAT KEITH ACTUALLY SAID

"Unless you missed Long Software (IGV +3.7% yesterday) and failed to cover your South Korea (EWY) and Semis (DRAM) shorts (we did), your Hedge Fund portfolio isn't a burning building this morning."

Keith McCullough, Early Look "Quad Shift = ATHs", 20:10 GMT+8, 14 Aug 2026

"July was a different story. Entire neighborhoods of consensus Hedge Funds burned down in #Quad4. Worst month for fundamental Long/Short in 4 years."

Same publication

"With a monthly Quad Count of 3-1-2, I need to shift the book towards more Quad 1 and 2 blends... That generally means moving towards smaller market caps ... And more 'Growth' vs. Rate Sensitivity"

Same publication. Read alongside the Russell's record close, this is the sentence that explains the session.

"Since we knew the US Inflation (CPI) report was going to be read by Macro Tourists as 'dovish', and the Short-End (UST 2yr Yield Signal) broke TRADE on that, we were able to do the following this week: Sell ALL my REIT exposure (XLRE) on a bright green day (XLRE was +1.4% yesterday) [and] Sell the rest of my Insurance (IAK) exposure"

Same publication

"QTUM & IGV in and XLRE & IAK out is a textbook Quad Shift."

Same publication

"Experienced firefighters don't run toward every alarm. They read the signals first. So do I."

Same publication

"I always ask investors one question: who gets you out?"

Same publication

From Thursday's Early Look, written by Brooks Cutright rather than McCullough (19:17 GMT+8, 13 Aug): "The monthly model has September in Quad 1 and October in Quad 2: two risk-on regimes back to back." Cutright's piece was about compulsory flows — capital that *must* move rather than chooses to — and flagged the **evening of 4 September** S&P 500 index announcement, with roughly ten companies currently clearing every published admission threshold on Hedgeye's screens and about 3% of every S&P dollar sitting in roughly 125 companies too small to be admitted under today's criteria. That is a dated, mechanical catalyst worth marking now.

The Macro Show, 22:21 GMT+8, 14 Aug. Hedgeye's own summary of this show is explicitly AI-enhanced and flagged as possibly containing errors, so nothing from it is quoted here as verbatim McCullough. Paraphrasing what it reports: dollar weakness remains the core macro position, expressed long yen and long euro; gold was increased again and moved up the allocation ranking; the Korea and semiconductor shorts were covered on the TRADE signal rather than a change of thesis; at all-time highs the book moved from buying to selling strength, taking Real-Time Alerts from eight longs and zero shorts to seven and two; Apple was reduced on a lower high and a bearish immediate-term setup, while Amazon was called a buy and added; New Zealand was trimmed and the Philippines increased, leaving him net long Asia with no Asian shorts; Qatar is described as the only country-level short; and Ethereum was sold on the TREND break. Bitcoin was characterised as bearish TRADE and TREND with no position change stated.

5 Mag7 scoreboard

NAME	LAST	DAY	CAP	READ
Nvidia	225.16	▼ 0.14 (−0.06%)	\$5.45T	Flat on 75.5m shares — by far the heaviest volume in the group. Reports 26 August , outside next week. The AI split around it did not move it.
Apple	305.93	▲ 0.67 (+0.22%)	\$4.47T	Green, and Hedgeye reduced into it — a lower high with a bearish immediate-term setup. If TREND breaks it becomes a short on that process.
Alphabet	345.90	▼ 0.46 (−0.13%)	\$4.22T	Range 344.50–350.45 — a 1.7% swing to a flat close. Best after-hours bid in the group, +0.37%.
Microsoft	495.40	▼ 1.48 (−0.30%)	\$3.68T	Failed at 500.01 intraday and closed under 496. Named on the Macro Show as a Signal Strength position.
Amazon	262.65	▼ 2.48 (−0.94%)	\$2.83T	Worst of the seven, closed 23 cents off the low — and it is the name Hedgeye explicitly said to keep adding to. That disagreement is the interesting part.
Broadcom (8th)	392.99	▼ 24.83 (−5.94%)	\$1.87T	\$118bn of market value gone in a session on a Bank of America note flagging roughly \$370bn of AI-related vehicle debt. No company news. Bounced 0.13% after hours.
Meta	589.85	▼ 5.12 (−0.86%)	\$1.50T	Broke 590 and closed 56 cents off the low after a 601.86 high. A 2.1% peak-to-trough day on no news.
Tesla	342.27	▲ 2.31 (+0.68%)	\$1.35T	Widest range in the group, 335.33–351.26 — 4.7%. Closed in the middle of it. Volume 45.4m.

Capitalisations are TradingView's `market_cap_basic` at the 06:07 GMT+8 capture, in US dollars. The seven Magnificent names total **\$23.50 trillion**; adding Broadcom takes the block to \$25.37 trillion. Broadcom is shown for context because it was the largest capitalisation loss of the session, not because it belongs to the seven.

6 Positioning & options

- **Volatility is priced for nothing.** VIX 14.26, down 2.60%, with a 14.18 low — 0.80 above the 52-week low and 0.21 above Hedgeye's band floor. The band's ceiling came in 0.51 versus Thursday, so even the model's worst case for the next few sessions is smaller than it was.
- **Hedgeye rebuilt short exposure at the highs.** Real-Time Alerts went from eight longs and zero shorts to seven longs and two shorts inside Friday's session — three longs sold, inventory replaced, two shorts initiated. That is the first two-sided book in a week, and it happened on a day the market closed lower.
- **Stated immediate-term upside of roughly 0.7–0.8% on the S&P** is the arithmetic behind the change. Off Thursday's 7,798.99 close that implies a ceiling around 7,853–7,861, which is where the published band ends.
- **Breadth confirmed but did not lead.** Equal-weight RSP finished +0.02% against the cap-weighted S&P's −0.17%, a 19bp spread in favour of the average stock; the NYSE Composite added 0.05%; IWM added 0.52%. The average stock had a better day than the index, but only just.
- **Rate volatility is the quiet one.** MOVE at 69.58 is below the 75 threshold Hedgeye cites, and it rose 0.51% on a day the long end sold off. Rate vol that will not rise while yields do is either complacency or conviction, and it is the cheapest hedge on the board either way.

- **The consensus long is the dollar.** Hedgeye describes long USD as the most consensus net-long position in macro on CFTC futures and options positioning, and is positioned against it via long yen and long euro. DXY fell 0.31% on Friday; the trade worked.
- **Concentration risk sits in one place.** Nvidia alone is \$5.45 trillion, 23.2% of the seven-name block. It reports on 26 August, after the FOMC minutes and after the Jackson Hole window.

7 Sector rotation — leaders & laggards

SPDR SECTOR	LAST	DAY	AFTER HOURS	VOLUME
Energy (XLE)	61.91	▲ +1.39%	−0.06%	22.76m
Utilities (XLU)	44.31	▲ +0.61%	−0.07%	17.14m
Materials (XLB)	52.54	▲ +0.44%	−0.17%	7.48m
Industrials (XLI)	186.51	▲ +0.39%	−0.01%	3.59m
Communication services (XLC)	112.95	▲ +0.36%	0.00%	2.98m
Real estate (XLRE)	45.27	▲ +0.33%	+0.13%	4.55m
Consumer staples (XLP)	86.09	▲ +0.11%	−0.08%	6.97m
Financials (XLF)	58.16	▼ −0.17%	−0.05%	28.13m
Consumer discretionary (XLY)	118.20	▼ −0.21%	−0.08%	3.84m
Technology (XLK)	190.01	▼ −0.40%	+0.10%	3.63m
Health care (XLV)	167.37	▼ −0.60%	+0.04%	5.02m

Day change and after-hours change from the same 06:07 GMT+8 capture. After-hours moves are small enough across the board that none of them is a signal on its own.

- **Leaders.** Energy, utilities and materials — the three most inflation-levered sectors in the index, on the day the consumer data broke. Energy has now added roughly 7% on the week.
- **Laggards.** Health care, technology and discretionary. XLV's −0.60% is notable because Hedgeye carries it as a bullish-TREND long sitting at 42.1% of its band; the weakness came from Eli Lilly's −2.39% and Johnson & Johnson's −0.66%, not from the sector.
- **Rotation.** Seven of eleven sectors closed green while the S&P closed red — the definition of a cap-weighted drag. Financials at 28.1m shares and energy at 22.8m carried the volume; technology traded only 3.6m ETF shares despite being the worst large sector, which means the tech selling was in single names, not in the sector.
- **The discretionary read is the one to hold.** XLY fell only 0.21% on a 0.6% retail sales miss and a 51.0 sentiment print. Either the sector is looking through the data to next week's retailer earnings, or it is not marking it at all. Wednesday and Thursday will settle that.

8 Forward — futures & the week ahead

There is no overnight tape to report and there will not be one until Globex reopens on Monday at 06:00 GMT+8. The CME closed at 17:00 ET on Friday, roughly an hour before this capture, so every futures level in this brief is Friday's settle rather than a live print: ES 7,805.00 on 839,974 lots, NQ 30,141.75 on 398,169, YM 53,807 on 43,243 and RTY 3,074.90 on 101,924. Cash FX and the metals fixes are likewise shut. Bitcoin at \$62,875.88 is the only instrument in this document that was genuinely trading at 06:07:13 GMT+8. Monday's edition will carry the first live futures prints of the week — thin, and priced against two days of accumulated headlines, with the gap between Friday's settle and the Globex reopen likely to be the single most useful number in it.

DAY (GMT+8)	KEY EVENTS
Mon 17 Aug	Japan Q2 GDP, 07:50. US Empire State manufacturing (Aug) and NAHB housing index, 20:30 and 22:00. Globex reopens 06:00. Earnings: Fabrinet.
Tue 18 Aug	US housing starts and building permits (Jul), 20:30. Earnings: Home Depot , Baidu, Toll Brothers.
Wed 19 Aug	EIA crude and product inventories, 22:30 — the number that prices the Hormuz stockpile draw. Earnings: Target , Lowe's , TJX , Analog Devices.
Thu 20 Aug	July FOMC minutes, 02:00 (Wed 14:00 ET) — the week's event, into a Fed that voted 9–3 in July with three members wanting a hike. Jobless claims and Philadelphia Fed, 20:30. Earnings: Walmart , Alibaba, NetEase, Deere, Ross Stores.
Fri 21 Aug	Flash S&P Global manufacturing and services PMIs, existing home sales, Conference Board leading index. Earnings: BJ's Wholesale. Jackson Hole — see footnote, the date is disputed.
Wed 26 Aug	Nvidia fiscal Q2 — outside next week, but it is what the semiconductor complex is trading against.

Fri 4 Sep

S&P 500 index committee announcement, US evening. Roughly ten companies clear every published admission threshold on Hedgeye's screens; about \$11 trillion tracks the answer.

Times converted at GMT+8 = ET + 12h and are indicative where the release time was not confirmed against the agency's own calendar. **Jackson Hole conflict:** one source places the symposium's start on **21 August**, another places it on **27–29 August** with the new Fed Chair's first address there. The brief has not resolved this; treat 21 August as the earlier of two claimed dates and verify against the Kansas City Fed before positioning around it. See section 18.

9 Corporate news

- **Broadcom** **–5.94% to 392.99**, on a Bank of America note flagging roughly \$370bn of AI-related vehicle debt. No company-specific bad news; the most recent quarter showed revenue up sharply with AI chip sales rising. Roughly **\$118bn of market value** on an analyst's balance-sheet framing.
- **Applied Materials** **–5.12% to 507.18**, the day after reporting. It *beat* and guided to more than 30% growth in semiconductor equipment spending for 2026, with advanced packaging up around 50% — and fell anyway, on unrealised investment losses and a forward multiple that had expanded to roughly 44x. Across its last five straight beats the average earnings-day move has been **–2.2%**. Hedgeye cited it as the counter-example to the memory names: a lower high followed by TRADE and TREND breaks preceding the fall.
- **AMD** **+6.50% to 514.39**, the best move in the large-cap complex, on a Street-high \$1,250 price target from Baird plus continued AI-chip momentum. It closed 28 cents off its high of the day.
- **Memory ran**. SanDisk **+7.40% to 1,641.11** — and up a further 1.33% after hours, the largest post-close move on the board. Western Digital **+4.41% to 508.80**, Micron **+2.30% to 971.66**. The KOSPI's return to a bull market and the memory tape are the same trade.
- **Oracle** **–3.65% to 150.52** and **Workday** **–3.76% to 198.68** — the enterprise software names went the opposite way to IGV's Thursday rally. Workday's 195.01–208.00 range is a 6.7% swing.
- **Palantir** **–2.78% to 174.04**, closing 24 cents off the low.
- **Eli Lilly** **–2.39% to 1,180.16**, which by itself explains most of health care's status as the worst sector. Range 1,171.20–1,199.00.
- **Intel** **–1.97% to 102.50** on 95.0m shares — the heaviest volume of any single stock in the capture, ahead of Nvidia. It then added 0.63% after hours, the second-largest post-close move.
- **Cisco** **–1.58% to 111.68**; **Tapestry** **+0.46% to 128.98** on a 126.14–129.88 range.
- **Reddit** rose on confirmation of S&P 500 inclusion — a compulsory-flow event of exactly the kind Thursday's Early Look was built around. **Range Resources** **–7.3%** on natural gas headwinds and price-target cuts, a reminder that the energy rally is crude, not gas.

10 Macro data

- **US retail sales, July** — **actual –0.6% m/m, consensus +0.1%**. Total retail and food services sales \$763.6bn. Ex-autos and gasoline **–0.2%**. Year-on-year **+5.0%**, decelerating from **+6.7%** in June and a revised **+7.3%** in May. Motor vehicles and parts **–1.8%**; **non-store retailers** **–2.2%**, which is the line that should worry anyone modelling e-commerce. Sharpest monthly fall since May 2025. Source: Census Bureau advance report.
- **University of Michigan consumer sentiment, August preliminary** — **actual 51.0, consensus 54.5** (Reuters; Bloomberg's panel had 55). Down from 55.2 final in July. Expectations 50.6 from 55.4; current conditions 51.8 from 54.8. Responses collected 28 July–10 August, a window in which the national average petrol price stayed above \$4 a gallon. Declines were broad across demographic and political lines, sharpest among Republicans, older consumers, lower-income households and those without a degree.
- **US CPI, July** — **released Wednesday 12 August, and every headline landed exactly on consensus**. Headline **+0.1% m/m and 3.4% y/y**, down from 3.5%; core **+0.2% m/m and 2.5% y/y**, down from 2.6%. Second consecutive annual deceleration as the Iran energy shock rolls off. This is the print McCullough said would be read as dovish by "Macro Tourists", and on which the 2-year yield signal broke TRADE.
- **Fed policy**. Target range held at **3.50–3.75%** at the July meeting on a **9–3 vote, with the three dissents favouring a quarter-point hike**, and a hint towards a hike in September. The Chair has been in post since 22 May and has held rates at back-to-back meetings; internal task forces are not due to report until year end, which argues for a longer hold than markets have priced.
- **The two Friday misses are one story**. A consumer paying above \$4 a gallon because a strait is closed is a consumer who buys fewer cars and less online. That the Fed's inflation print is cooling at the same time as the consumer's own inflation experience is not, is the tension the FOMC minutes will be read for on Thursday.

11 Geopolitics

- ♦ **The Strait of Hormuz remains the single largest live variable in global markets**. Transits have collapsed from roughly 130 a day before the conflict to single-digit and low-double-digit counts on recent days. Shipping through a waterway that carried about a

fifth of global oil supply has been effectively suspended since late February. The IEA has warned that reopening is becoming more pressing as stockpiles draw down.

- ▲ **Iran and Oman have agreed the geographical coordinates of a proposed safe shipping corridor**, with talks described by participants as professional and progressing and a joint statement being finalised. This is the most constructive development in months and is the main downside risk to crude from here.
- ▼ **Iran's foreign minister has said the waterway will not reopen until Washington eases sanctions and pays war reparations** — his framing, not a settled fact. Iran also denies direct negotiations with the United States; any contact is likely indirect, via Pakistan, Qatar, Turkey and Egypt. A technical ceasefire is in place and the conflict has nonetheless intensified in recent weeks.
- ◆ **An oil spill off Oman now covers an estimated 500 square miles** and has reached the mainland roughly 200km from a stranded tanker in the Arabian Sea. Environmental liability of this scale becomes a political constraint on any reopening deal.
- ▼ **Black Sea infrastructure continues to burn at both ends**. Russian and Ukrainian strikes have set ships and port facilities alight. Chicago wheat's +3.37% on Friday is the cleanest market expression of it, and it went almost entirely unremarked.
- ◆ **Australia, Japan and the United States are converging on a shared threat assessment of China's missile, drone, submarine and long-range bomber build-out**. No single dated catalyst, but it is the structural bid under Asian defence and under the Taiwan risk premium that USD/TWD at 31.924 is not currently pricing.

12 Overnight setup — what Asia opens into

Asia does not open for another 50 hours. This is a Saturday edition: Tokyo and Seoul next trade on Monday from 08:00–08:30 GMT+8, Hong Kong from 09:30, India from 12:15. What follows is therefore the hand Asia will be dealt on Monday, not a live overnight tape. Every level below is Friday's settle or close except Bitcoin and Ether.

INSTRUMENT	LEVEL	CHANGE	VOLUME	STATUS
ES E-mini S&P	7,805.00	−0.22%	839,974	Fri settle, Globex shut
NQ E-mini Nasdaq-100	30,141.75	−0.16%	398,169	Fri settle
YM E-mini Dow	53,807	−0.24%	43,243	Fri settle, thin
RTY E-mini Russell	3,074.90	+0.48%	101,924	Fri settle
USD/JPY	159.316	−0.13%	239,849	Fri close, FX shut
USD/KRW	1,416.64	−0.09%	63,464	Fri close
USD/TWD	31.924	−0.52%	46,070	Fri close
USD/CNH	6.73985	−0.07%	72,083	Fri close
EUR/USD	1.15670	+0.33%	120,332	Fri close
Gold spot	4,376.33	+0.58%	—	Fri close
Silver spot	64.685	+0.39%	—	Fri close
Copper spot	6.5595	+0.31%	47,158	Fri close
WTI crude	82.40	+1.42%	164,535	Fri settle
Brent crude	88.52	+1.67%	27,826	Fri settle
Bitcoin	62,875.88	−0.86%	—	LIVE 06:07:13
Ether	1,879.12	−0.28%	—	LIVE 06:07:13

Previous Asian closes, Friday 14 August, all marked as such: Nikkei 225 68,713.58 +0.59%; KOSPI 6,977.95 +2.42%; Hang Seng 25,116.86 −1.10%; SSE Composite 3,927.18 +0.01%; ASX 200 9,115.20 −0.80%; Sensex 78,009.25 −0.09%. Europe: DAX 26,440.31 +0.53%; Euro Stoxx 50 6,539.60 −0.09%; FTSE 100 10,750.12 −0.21%; CAC 40 8,636.81 −0.16%; IBEX 20,156.61 −0.06%.

- **The US tape hands Asia energy and small caps, and hands it a technology problem.** XLE +1.39% and the Russell's record against XLK −0.40% is not a mix that maps cleanly onto Asian indices, which are overwhelmingly technology and exporters. The read-through is selective: memory yes, equipment no.
- **Korea is the instrument most likely to move.** The KOSPI added 2.42% on Friday to 6,977.95 and is back in a bull market on the memory cycle; Hedgeye covered its EWY short on the TRADE signal reclaiming 6,853. Monday's cash open has to price two more sessions of memory strength — SanDisk closed +7.4% and added 1.3% after hours — against Applied Materials' −5.1%. Korea gets the good half of the split.

- **Taiwan gets the ambiguous half.** USD/TWD fell 0.52%, the largest Asian FX move of the session, which is currency support for the index and margin pressure for its exporters. TSMC's customers went in both directions on Friday.
- **Japan opens into a firmer yen and its own Q2 GDP print at 07:50 on Monday.** USD/JPY at 159.316 traded as low as 158.602. Hedgeye holds both the yen and Japanese equities as bullish signals simultaneously and explicitly refuses the conventional framing that a stronger yen must hurt the Nikkei.
- **Hong Kong and China are the negative outliers.** The Hang Seng fell 1.10% on Friday while everything around it rose. Hedgeye has China bearish on both TRADE and TREND but is **not yet short**, because the level to initiate has not arrived. USD/CNH at 6.73985 is a firm yuan and does not corroborate a China risk-off.
- **Watch Bitcoin over the weekend.** It is the only market that will trade before Monday's open, it is 50.2% below its record, and Ether just lost its Hedgeye long. A weekend crypto move is the one thing that can change the tone Asia opens into, and there will be nothing else to price against it.

13 AI watch

- **The model price war has reached the frontier tier.** OpenAI cut pricing on GPT-5.6 substantially and Anthropic positioned Claude Opus 5 at roughly half the price of its higher-end Fable 5, as lower-cost Chinese competitors take users. Cheaper frontier inference expands volume, and volume is what pulls HBM, DRAM and NAND — which is the mechanical link between a price war and Friday's memory rally.
- **Anthropic is reported to be negotiating to acquire Israeli real-time video and world-model startup Decart AI at around \$6bn,** and reported its first profitable quarter on \$10.9bn of revenue. An OpenAI S-1 is described as imminent. Reported, not confirmed by the companies.
- **Big Tech's disclosed AI purchase commitments are approaching \$1.5 trillion.** That figure is the ground under Bank of America's \$370bn AI-vehicle-debt note, and the note took \$118bn off Broadcom in a session. The financing structure of the buildout, not the demand for it, is now the thing that moves prices.
- **Vantage Data Centers is exploring options including an IPO at roughly \$100bn,** with involvement in the Wisconsin campus tied to the Stargate buildout. A listing at that mark would be the first public print on private data-centre value in this cycle.
- **SanDisk and SK Hynix have published the first industry standard for High Bandwidth Flash through the Open Compute Project.** A cross-vendor AI memory hierarchy expands the addressable market for every flash supplier — which is the structural, rather than cyclical, reason the memory names keep going up.

14 Beyond the markets

- **The Michigan survey fell hardest among Republicans, older consumers and households without a degree** — the demographic that has been most insulated in recent sentiment prints. When sentiment declines stop being partisan, they are usually about a price the respondent pays every week. In this case it is \$4-plus petrol.
- **Non-store retail fell 2.2% in July.** Online spending is the category that is supposed to be structurally immune to a soft month. It was the second-worst line in the report.
- **An oil spill off Oman now covers around 500 square miles.** It will outlast the shipping negotiation, and it gives every party to that negotiation a reason to be seen doing something about the strait.
- **The July long/short drawdown was the worst month for fundamental long/short in four years,** on Hedgeye's account. Six weeks later the Russell is at a record. Nothing about the recovery in the index tells you the capital that was liquidated has come back.
- **Netflix trades at \$78.16 and Tapestry at \$128.98.** Share counts and splits have quietly made nominal price a useless cross-sectional signal — Netflix's \$325bn capitalisation sits on a two-digit share price while Workday's \$49bn sits on a three-digit one. Worth remembering before reading any screen sorted by price.
- **Chicago wheat rose 3.37%.** It was the largest single move in the commodity complex on Friday, larger than crude's, and it appeared in no market wrap.

15 Appendix — stock cards

NVDA · NVIDIA

225.16 ▼ 0.06%

Cap \$5.45T · vol 75.5m · no published Hedgeye band · reports 26 Aug

Flat on the heaviest single-stock volume in the capture. Range 224.50–227.49. It did not participate in either half of Friday's semiconductor split,

AVGO · BROADCOM

392.99 ▼ 5.94%

Cap \$1.87T · vol 29.4m · after hours +0.13% · range 388.50–412.50

which is unusual for the sector's largest weight and worth watching into the print.

Roughly \$118bn of value on a sell-side balance-sheet note flagging \$370bn of AI-vehicle debt, not on company news. Closed 4.49 off the low. The largest capitalisation loss of the session by a wide margin.

AMD · ADVANCED MICRO DEVICES

514.39 ▲ 6.50%

Cap \$840bn · vol 25.5m · after hours +0.18% · range 483.20–514.67

Best large-cap move of the day on a Street-high \$1,250 target from Baird. Closed 28 cents off the high — a full-strength close, not a fade. The 6.5% gain against Broadcom's -5.9% is the custom-silicon-versus-merchant split in one line.

AMAT · APPLIED MATERIALS

507.18 ▼ 5.12%

Cap \$403bn · vol 13.1m · range 497.10–523.00 · reported 13 Aug

Beat, guided to 30%-plus equipment growth and about 50% in advanced packaging, and fell on unrealised investment losses and a ~44x forward multiple. Five straight beats have averaged a -2.2% earnings-day move. Hedgeye's stated example of a lower high preceding TRADE and TREND breaks.

SNDK · SANDISK

1,641.11 ▲ 7.40%

Cap \$243bn · vol 20.8m · after hours +1.33% · range 1,565.00–1,667.19

The strongest name on the board and the strongest after-hours move. NAND contract prices rose 85–90% then 55–60% quarter-on-quarter across Q1 and Q2. Hedgeye covered its DRAM short as this and Micron pushed the complex back to a bullish TRADE signal.

MU · MICRON

971.66 ▲ 2.30%

Cap \$1.10T · vol 27.7m · after hours +0.23% · range 956.20–984.00

A trillion-dollar memory company — a sentence that would not have parsed two years ago. Fiscal Q3 revenue rose 345.7% year-on-year. It has crossed into the size where it moves the SOX on its own.

WDC · WESTERN DIGITAL

508.80 ▲ 4.41%

Cap \$175bn · vol 9.9m · after hours +0.14% · range 487.10–516.35

Third leg of the storage trade, and the smallest of the three by capitalisation, which is why it moves most on the same news. A 5.8% intraday range on a 4.4% close means it was bought into the bell.

ORCL · ORACLE

150.52 ▼ 3.65%

Cap \$434bn · vol 21.8m · range 148.80–156.39

Fell 3.6% the day after software as a factor rose 3.7%, which tells you the IGV rally was not an Oracle rally. It is the most exposed large-cap to the Stargate financing question that the Bank of America note reframed.

AMZN · AMAZON

262.65 ▼ 0.94%

Cap \$2.83T · vol 27.2m · after hours +0.09% · range 262.42–265.81

Worst of the Magnificent Seven, closed 23 cents off the low — and the one name Hedgeye explicitly said to keep adding to, calling the setup a significant buying opportunity. A -2.2% month in non-store retail on the same day is the tension in that call.

LLY · ELI LILLY

1,180.16 ▼ 2.39%

Cap \$1.11T · vol 2.3m · after hours +0.13% · range 1,171.20–1,199.00

Carried health care to last place among the eleven sectors. XLV nonetheless holds a bullish Hedgeye TREND at 42.1% of a band that shifted up a point — the sector signal and the largest constituent are pointing opposite ways.

PLTR · PALANTIR

174.04 ▼ 2.78%

Cap \$418bn · vol 24.0m · range 173.80–180.18

Closed 24 cents off the session low, a full-weakness close. A \$418bn capitalisation on a high-beta AI narrative is the cleanest single-stock proxy for whether the AI financing question is being priced.

INTC · INTEL

102.50 ▼ 1.97%

Cap \$517bn · vol 95.0m · after hours +0.63% · range 102.05–106.87

The heaviest volume of any single name in the capture — more than Nvidia. Closed 45 cents off the low of a 4.7% range, then bid 0.63% after hours. Volume of that size on a -2% close is distribution or accumulation, and the after-hours bid argues for the latter.

16 About this edition

- **Covers** — Friday 14 August's US cash session as settled (close 04:00 GMT+8 today), the after-hours tape to the capture, and the Globex session to its 17:00 ET Friday close. Asian cash markets do not reopen until Monday.
- **Captured** — one window, **06:07:13–06:07:16 GMT+8, 2.3 seconds**, 96 instruments, via the standard capture script. TradingView returned 96 of 96; Yahoo returned 0 of 62 and aborted on a circuit breaker after five consecutive HTTP 429s. **This run is TradingView-single-sourced.** Consequences are set out in full in section 18.
- **Settled versus live** — every equity, futures, FX, rates and metals row is Friday's settle or close, roughly one to two hours old at capture, because Globex, cash FX and the metals fixes were shut. **Bitcoin and Ether are the only live rows in this brief.**
- **Hedgeye edition** — **FULL HEDGEYE EDITION**; the logged-in feed was reached without incident. The live risk-range set is the Early Look "**Quad Shift = ATHs**" by **Keith McCullough**, 20:10 GMT+8 on 14 August — the newest that exists, since Hedgeye does not publish at weekends. It governs this edition and Sunday's and Monday's, and is superseded by Monday evening GMT+8.

Also read in full: Thursday's Early Look by Brooks Cutright for the prior-day band comparison, the Macro Show summary and replay notes of 22:21 GMT+8, the ETF Pro Plus change of 22:40 GMT+8, and the Macro Week Summary Notes header of 05:44 GMT+8 this morning.

- **Quad path — 3 → 1 → 2, unchanged** from the prior edition. August Quad 3, September Quad 1, October Quad 2. The path did not change; the *positioning for it* did, materially, this week.
- **Not available** — Yahoo Finance in its entirety; the body of the Macro Week Summary Notes and the ETF Pro dashboard, which sit behind further clicks; IGV, which is a new entry on the Hedgeye sheet and was not in the capture universe, so its band position is unmeasured rather than estimated; and any Asian or European live tape, since all are shut.

17 Sources

Prices. All levels from a single concurrent capture at 06:07:13–06:07:16 GMT+8 on 15 August 2026 via TradingView's bulk scanner: cash indices, index futures, Treasury yields including the 2-year cash series, energy and metals on both spot and futures, FX, crypto, the eleven SPDR sector funds, the major ETFs and 23 single names with capitalisations and after-hours prints. Yahoo Finance was queried in the same window as the independent cross-check and returned nothing.

Hedgeye. The logged-in research feed at app.hedgeye.com: Early Look "Quad Shift = ATHs" (Keith McCullough, 20:10 GMT+8, 14 Aug) for the live risk ranges and Quad count; Early Look "PLAY THE HAND YOU'RE DEALT" (Brooks Cutright, 19:17 GMT+8, 13 Aug) for the prior-day bands and the September index-event framing; The Macro Show summary and replay notes (22:21 GMT+8, 14 Aug), which Hedgeye labels AI-enhanced; ETF Pro Plus update (22:40 GMT+8, 14 Aug); Macro Week Summary Notes (05:44 GMT+8, 15 Aug).

Macro. Census Bureau advance retail and food services report for July; University of Michigan Surveys of Consumers August preliminary; Bureau of Labor Statistics July CPI. Consensus figures and reaction from Reuters, Bloomberg, CNBC, NBC News and Investing Live. Federal Reserve July decision and vote split via CNN, Chase and Axios reporting on the Chair's communications.

Session narrative and single stocks. TheStreet, CNBC, Yahoo Finance, Kiplinger and TradingKey for the Friday recap, weekly index performance and the Russell record; Benzinga, 24/7 Wall St., Vantage and stockdownunder for Applied Materials, Broadcom, AMD and the memory complex; 24/7 Wall St. and IG for DRAM and NAND contract pricing and the KOSPI's return to a bull market.

Commodities, geopolitics and AI. CNN live coverage of 5 and 13 August and Al Jazeera of 10 August for Hormuz transit counts and the Iran–Oman corridor talks; Geopolitical Futures and the Conference Board for the wider assessment; the IEA via the same coverage on stockpile draw. AI items from Tech Startups' daily briefings of 12–14 August and AIToolsRecap. Where an item is a report rather than a company confirmation, the brief says so.

18 Data-confidence

CROSS-CHECKS PASSED

- **Cash index arithmetic is internally self-consistent to five decimal places on all five indices.** S&P: 7,785.76 close less a −13.23 change implies a 7,798.99 prior close; $-13.23 \div 7,798.99 = -0.16964\%$, matching the vendor's stated −0.16964%. Nasdaq: 26,729.1644 on a 26,803.0250 prior = −0.27557%, stated −0.27557%. Dow: 53,732.41 on 53,839.99 = −0.19981%, stated −0.20%. Russell: 3,068.4154 on 3,052.8467 = +0.50997%, stated +0.51%. SOX: 12,417.0402 on 12,455.9985 = −0.31277%, stated −0.31%. Every close also sits inside its own reported high–low range.
- **Futures reconcile to cash on basis and to their own prior settles.** ES at 7,805.00 is 19.24 over the S&P, YM at 53,807 is 74.59 over the Dow, RTY at 3,074.90 is 6.48 over the Russell — all normal carry-and-dividend basis for the September contracts, none anomalous. Each contract's change reconciles against Thursday's settle, and each close sits inside its stated range.
- **The Russell record was verified two ways.** Friday's session high of 3,069.708728 is *identical* to the vendor's 52-week high field, which is the arithmetic confirmation that the record was set on Friday rather than earlier; press reporting of a fresh Russell record independently corroborates it. The close of 3,068.42 is 1.29 below that high.
- **Hedgeye bands were measured on the exact series each published line names** — spot for gold, silver and copper, continuous contract for crude and natural gas. The bases at capture were gold 1.393%, copper 0.816% and silver 0.654%. Measuring gold on December futures instead of spot would have placed it at 73.2% of its band rather than the true **54.3%**, and copper at 51.0% rather than **33.2%**. Both errors would have been material to the read.
- **Every band was compared against the prior day's published set** rather than reported in isolation. Fifteen of sixteen instruments carried over; XLRE dropped off with the position sale and IGV replaced it. Thirteen bands changed, eleven of them narrowing.
- **Capture reconciliation counts, stated plainly: 0 matched within 5 basis points, 0 minor, 0 divergent, 57 pairs single-sourced.** There were no divergences to resolve because there was no second source. That is a weak pass, and it is recorded as one, not dressed up.

KNOWN CONFLICTS AND WEAK MARKS

- **The RBOB gasoline change of −7.15% is rejected as a price move.** It implies a 3.128 prior reference, while the contract's own session ran 2.8327–2.9096 and closed at 2.9044, above its 2.8496 open. A contract that closes above its open cannot have fallen 7%; this is a roll or continuous-series discontinuity. The brief reports the level and the intra-session direction and prints "n/m" for the change. Anyone using the vendor number would have read a gasoline collapse into a consumer story where none occurred.

- **The Jackson Hole date is genuinely disputed and the brief has not resolved it.** One source places the symposium's start on 21 August alongside that day's PMI and claims data; another places it on 27–29 August and describes the new Fed Chair's first address there. Both are secondary. The week-ahead table carries the earlier date with the conflict flagged in its footnote. Verify against the Kansas City Fed before treating either as fixed.
- **Thursday's S&P record is reported two different ways in the press and the difference matters.** The implied prior close of 7,798.99 is a record *close* but is below 7,800; the 7,816.70 in the 52-week-high field is an intraday record. Reports describing the index as "clearing 7,800 for the first time" are describing the intraday print. The brief uses 7,798.99 for the close and 7,816.70 for the intraday high, and says which is which.
- **IGV's position in its 99.00–110.00 band is not measured.** It is a new entry on Hedgeye's sheet and was not in the capture universe, so no live level was seen this morning. Estimating it from Thursday's reported +3.7% would have been a fabrication; it is left blank instead.
- **Market capitalisations carry vendor-model uncertainty of roughly 1–2%.** They are TradingView's basic-shares calculation at capture, not company-reported diluted counts, and were not cross-checked against a second source this run. The \$118bn figure quoted for Broadcom's loss is derived from the same field applied to a –5.94% move and inherits that tolerance; treat it as approximately \$115–120bn.
- **Weekly index performance figures (+0.4% S&P, +0.1% Nasdaq, –0.6% Dow, ~+7% energy) are from press reporting, not computed from captured data,** because the capture returns daily fields only and the Yahoo multi-day bars that would normally verify them were unavailable. They are directionally corroborated by the daily prints but are not independently verified here.
- **The Macro Show content is Hedgeye's own AI-generated summary and is labelled by Hedgeye as possibly containing errors.** Nothing from it appears inside quotation marks in this brief. The summary itself notes that one of the three macro shorts it lists is garbled in the transcript and cannot be identified — so the short book as presented is incomplete by Hedgeye's own admission.
- **Fed policy details — the 3.50–3.75% range, the 9–3 July vote and the September hike hint — are from secondary reporting, not from the FOMC statement itself.** Thursday's minutes are the primary document and will supersede this characterisation.

KNOWN GAPS

- **The entire second price source was unavailable.** Yahoo Finance returned 0 of 62 requests and the circuit breaker tripped on five consecutive HTTP 429s — the container's IP is being throttled. The design worked as intended, costing about two seconds rather than eight minutes, but the cost is real: **57 instrument pairs are single-sourced and nothing in this brief has been checked against an independent vendor.** The internal arithmetic checks above are necessary but not sufficient; they cannot detect a systematically wrong feed.
- **The Macro Week Summary Notes and the ETF Pro Plus dashboard were reached only at header level.** Both sit behind an additional click into a separate dashboard. The Macro Dashboard, VIX Gauge, US Monthly Quad Forecast and Chart of the Week listed in the summary's contents were not read this morning. Anything in them that would have refined the Quad or dashboard section is missing from this edition.
- **Absence of a Hedgeye position change since Friday's publications is not evidence that none occurred.** Real-Time Alerts, Signal Strength Stocks and Portfolio Solutions all publish intraday and the feed was read once, at 06:07 GMT+8. The Signal Strength Stocks note of 75 stocks with 2 added and 3 removed, and the Portfolio Solutions daily ETF re-rank, were visible in the feed but not opened. Any position change inside them is unrecorded here.
- **No PPI figure was located for July 2026** despite a direct search. The macro section reports CPI and omits PPI rather than substituting an estimate.
- **No live Asian, European or Globex tape exists this morning** and none is presented. Every Asian and European level in section 12 is Friday's close, labelled as such. Nothing in this brief describes what markets are doing right now except Bitcoin and Ether.
- **Geopolitical items are attributed rather than asserted.** Iran's reopening conditions are the foreign minister's stated position; the Iran–Oman corridor agreement is as described by participants; the Iran–US negotiation question is contested by Iran itself. None of these is treated as settled fact.
- **Consensus figures for the housing, Empire State and PMI releases in the week-ahead table were not gathered.** The table lists the events, not expectations.

TIMING & UNVERIFIED

- **The capture window was 06:07:13–06:07:16 GMT+8 on 15 August 2026 — 2.3 seconds, well inside the ten-minute standard.** No top-up pass was needed and no row in this brief was captured outside that window.
- **Almost nothing here is current, and that is a property of Saturday rather than a defect.** The US cash close was at 04:00 GMT+8, roughly two hours before capture. Globex settled at 05:00 GMT+8, roughly an hour before. Cash FX and the metals fixes closed with it. **Only Bitcoin and Ether were trading at 06:07:13,** and they will keep trading all weekend — by Monday's edition the crypto levels in this document will be the only ones that have changed, and they may have changed a great deal.

- **The Hedgeye risk ranges are the freshest set that exists and will remain so until Monday evening GMT+8.** They were computed off Thursday's close and published Friday morning ET, so by Monday's open they will be three sessions old while still being current. That is not a carry-forward of a stale set; it is the correct set, and the weekend is simply long. Tonight's and tomorrow's editions inherit it.
- **The 92.5% Russell band reading and the 8.8% VIX reading are the two most time-sensitive numbers in this document.** Both are measured against bands built before Friday's session and both sit at an extreme of their range. A single Monday session can invalidate either.
- **The FOMC minutes on Thursday supersede the Fed characterisation in section 10,** and Nvidia on 26 August supersedes the semiconductor framing in sections 2, 9 and 15.
- **Verify every price in this brief against a live feed before acting on it.** Nothing here is a recommendation, no level was seen more recently than 06:07:13 GMT+8, and the run had no second price source to check itself against.